



AUDIO SCRIPT

READ ALOUD BY THE TEACHER · FOR THE TEACHER ONLY

A2 · about 310 words · 3 minutes at reading speed · read twice: once at normal speed, once pausing at ||

- 1 Hello, and welcome to *Great Lives*. Today: a queen who ruled England for forty-four years. ||
- 2 Elizabeth was born on the seventh of September, fifteen thirty-three, at Greenwich Palace, near London. Her father was King Henry the Eighth. Her mother was Anne Boleyn. When Elizabeth was two years old, her father had her mother killed. People said the little girl was not a real princess. ||
- 3 But Elizabeth was clever. She studied with a famous teacher, Roger Ascham. She learned Latin, French and Italian. She read and she read and she read. ||
- 4 Life was not safe. In March fifteen fifty-four her sister Mary sent her to the Tower of London. Elizabeth stayed in the Tower for about two months. After that she lived in the country for almost a year, and soldiers watched her door. She was not free. ||
- 5 Everything changed in fifteen fifty-eight. Mary died, and on the seventeenth of November Elizabeth became queen. She was twenty-five years old. In January fifteen fifty-nine they crowned her in Westminster Abbey. ||
- 6 Many men wanted to marry her. Kings and princes sent her letters and pictures. Elizabeth said no. She said no to all of them, and she kept the power herself. Today people call her the Virgin Queen. ||
- 7 In fifteen eighty-eight the King of Spain sent a great fleet of ships – the Armada – against England. Elizabeth went to Tilbury and spoke to her soldiers. She said: “I know I have the body but of a weak, feeble woman; but I have the heart and stomach of a king.” The Armada lost. ||
- 8 Elizabeth loved the theatre. In her time William Shakespeare and Christopher Marlowe wrote their plays, and people still watch them today. ||
- 9 Elizabeth died on the twenty-fourth of March, sixteen oh three, at Richmond Palace. She was queen for forty-four years. King James of Scotland became the next king of England. ||
- 10 So – what makes a great person? Think about Elizabeth. She was clever. She was brave. And she said no.

HOW TO READ IT

First reading: normal speed, no stopping, students only tick task 2. Second reading: slow down a little and pause where you see ||. If the group is weak, read paragraph 7 a third time on its own – the quotation is the hardest line on the sheet.



LISTENING SHEET · ANSWER KEY

1 BEFORE YOU LISTEN 1 e · 2 a · 3 b · 4 g · 5 f · 6 d · 7 h · 8 c

2 FIRST LISTENING 1 tick · 2 – · 3 tick · 4 – · 5 tick · 6 tick · 7 – · 8 tick

3 SECOND LISTENING 1 F · 2 T · 3 T · 4 T · 5 T · 6 F · 7 NG · 8 T

4 THE NUMBERS 1 d · 2 g · 3 b · 4 a · 5 c · 6 e · 7 f

5 AFTER Open answers. Item 3 is the one to push on: the talk really does leave out everything difficult, and noticing that is the skill the afternoon needs.

WHY ITEM 7 OF TASK 3 IS NOT GIVEN

The talk says Shakespeare wrote his plays in her time. It never says she met him or wrote with him. Students who answer F are reading the world, not the text; students who answer T are reading a film. Both are worth thirty seconds of discussion.

IF YOU WOULD RATHER NOT READ IT YOURSELF

The script is plain text and works in any text-to-speech tool; a British English voice at 0.9 speed is close to the timing above. There is no recording in this pack.

THREE MORE WAYS TO USE THE SAME SCRIPT

1 · RUNNING DICTATION · 8 MINUTES

Cut the script into its ten paragraphs and tape them to the walls. One student in each pair runs, reads, comes back and dictates; the other writes. Swap after every paragraph. Then they compare their text with the real one and count the differences. It is loud, and it is the fastest reading-and-spelling exercise there is.

2 · SHADOWING PARAGRAPH 7 · 4 MINUTES

Read the Tilbury paragraph one line at a time; the class repeats it back at the same speed and with the same stress. Then one volunteer stands up and says the quotation alone. Nobody forgets a sentence they have said standing up.

3 · RETELL RELAY · 6 MINUTES

Books closed. Student 1 gives one sentence of the life, in the Past Simple. Student 2 gives the next. Any wrong tense and the chain goes back to the start. Three complete chains and the group owns the story.

WHERE THE FACTS COME FROM

CHECKED ON 13.09.2026

Every date, name and number in the script is in the English Wikipedia article “Elizabeth I”: born 7 September 1533 at Greenwich Palace; Anne Boleyn beheaded 19 May 1536; tutored by Roger Ascham; sent to the Tower on 18 March 1554 and moved to Woodstock on 22 May; queen from 17 November 1558, crowned 15 January 1559; the Armada defeated in 1588; Shakespeare and Marlowe writing in her reign; died 24 March 1603 at Richmond Palace; succeeded by James VI of Scotland. The Tilbury quotation is from the article “Speech to the Troops at Tilbury”, 9 August 1588 – accepted as genuine by most historians, doubted by a minority. The class text’s “14 March” and “45 years” are wrong and are corrected here.